RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization con cerning the functions of the Committee, RECALLING ALSO article 10 of the International C onvention on Standards of Training, Certification and Watchkeeping for Fishing Vessel Pe rsonnel, 1995 (1995 STCW -F Convention), concerning the procedures for amending the 199 5 STCW-F Convention, HAVING CONSIDERED, at its 108th session, draft amendments to the an nex to the 1995 --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/Indexo fIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf HAVING CONSIDERED, at its 108th session, draft amendments to the annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention, circulated in accordance wi th article 10.2.1 thereof, 1 ADOPTS, in accordance with article 10.2.4 of the 1995 STCW -F Convention, amendments to the annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention, the text of which is set out in the annex to the present resolution; 2 DETERMINES, in accordance with arti cle 10.2.7.2 of the 1995 STCW-F Convention, that said amendments shall be deemed to have been accepted on 1 July 2025, unless, prior to that date, more than one third of the Par ties have notified the Secretary -General of the Organization that they object to the am endments; 3 INVITES the Parties to note that, in accordance with article 10.2.9 of the 1 995 STCW-F Convention, the amendments annexed hereto shall enter into force on 1 January 2026 upon their acceptance in accordance with paragraph 2 above; 4 REQUESTS the Secretar y -General, for the purposes of article 10.2.5 --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localreso urces/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf on 1 Janu ary 2026 upon their acceptance in accordance with paragraph 2 above; 4 REQUESTS the Secr etary -General, for the purposes of article 10.2.5 of the 1995 STCW-F Convention, to tra nsmit certified copies of the present resolution and the text of the amendments containe d in the annex to all Parties to the 1995 STCW-F Convention; 5 ALSO REQUESTS the Secreta ry-General to transmit copies of this resolution and its annex to Members of the Organiz ation which are not Parties to the 1995 STCW-F Convention.

6 FURTHER REQUESTS the Secretary-General to prepare a consolidated certified text of the 1995 STCW-F Convention.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNAT IONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VE SSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) - 2 - ANNEX AMENDMENT S TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND --- URL: h ttps://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolut ions/MSC.561(108).pdf - 2 - ANNEX AMENDMENTS TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARD S OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSONNEL (STCW-F), 199 5 Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention CHAPTER I General provisions Regulation I/ 1 Definitions 1 For the purpose of this annex, the following definitions apply: .1 Regul ations means regulations contained in the annex to the Convention; .2 Approved means app roved by the Party in accordance with these regulations; .3 Skipper means the person hav ing command of a fishing vessel; .4 Officer means a member of the crew, other than the s kipper, designated as such by national law or regulations or, in the absence of such des ignation, by collective agreement or custom; .5 Officer in charge of a navigational watc h means an officer qualified in accordance with the provisions of regulation II/2 or II/ 4 of this Convention; .6 Engineer officer means an officer qualified in accordance with the provisions --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/Indexof IMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf .6 Engineer officer means an officer qual ified in accordance with the provisions of regulation II/5-1-1, II/5-1-2 or II/5-2 of th is Convention; .7 Chief engineer officer means the senior engineer officer responsible f or the mechanical propulsion and operation and maintenance of mechanical and electrical installations of the vessel; .8 Second engineer officer means the engineer officer next in rank to the chief engineer officer and upon whom the responsibility for the mechanica l propulsion and the operation and maintenance of the mechanical and electrical installa tions of the vessel will fall in the event of t he incapacity of the chief engineer offi cer; .9 Radio operator means a person holding an appropriate certificate issued or recog nized by an Administration under the provisions of the Radio Regulations; .10 Radio Regu lations means the Radio Regulations complementing the Constitution and Convention of the International Telecommunication Union --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/ KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf .10 Radio Regulati ons means the Radio Regulations complementing the Constitution and Convention of the Int ernational Telecommunication Union which is in force at any given time; .11 1978 STCW Co nvention means the International Convention on Standards of Training, Certification and Watchkeeping for Seafarers, 1978; .12 1993 Torremolinos Protocol means the Torremolinos Protocol of 1993 relating to the Torremolinos International Convention for the Safety of

Fishing Vessels, 1977; RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO TH
E ANNEX TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATC
HKEEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention
) - 3 - .13 2012 Cape Town Agreement means the Cape Town Agreement of 2012 on the Implem
entation of the Provisions of the 1993 Torremolinos Protocol relating to the Torremolino
s International Convention for the Safety of Fishing Vessels, 1977; --- URL: https://www
cdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.5
61(108).pdf relating to the Torremolinos International Convention for the Safety of Fish
ing Vessels, 1977; .14 Month means a calendar month or 30 days made up of periods of les
s than one month; .15 Seagoing service means service on board a vessel relevant to the i
ssue or revalidation of a certificate or other qualification; .16 Propulsion power means
the total maximum continuous rated output power, in kilowatts, of all the vessel's main
propulsion machinery which appears on the vessel's certificate of registry or other offi
cial document; .17 Limited waters means those waters in the vicinity of a Party as defin
ed by its Administration within which a degree of safety is considered to exist which en
ables the standards of qualification and certification for all fishing vessel personnel
to be set at a lower level than for service outside the defined limits.

In determining the extent of limited waters, the Administration shall take into --- URL:
https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolu
tions/MSC.561(108).pdf In determining the extent of limited waters, the Administration s
hall take into consideration the guidelines developed by the Organization; .18 Unlimited
waters mean waters beyond limited waters; .19 Length (L) shall be taken as 96% of the to
tal length on a waterline at 85% of the least moulded depth measured from the keel line,
or as the length from the foreside of the stem to the axis of the rudder stock on that w
aterline, if that be greater.

In vessels designed with rake of keel the waterline on which this length is measured sha
ll be parallel to the designed waterline; .20 Moulded depth is the vertical distance mea
sured from the keel line to the top of the working deck beam at side; .21 STCW-F Code me
ans the Standards of Training, Certification and Watchkeeping for Fishing Vessel Personn
el Code, as adopted by resolution MSC.562(108), as may be amended by the Organization; .
22 Owner means the owner of the fishing vessel or any other organization or --- URL: htt
ps://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutio
ns/MSC.561(108).pdf MSC.562(108), as may be amended by the Organization; .22 Owner means
the owner of the fishing vessel or any other organization or person, such as the manager
, agent, operator, company, authorized representative or bareboat charterer, who has ass
umed the responsibility for the operation of the vessel from the owner an d who, on assu
ming such responsibility, has agreed to take over the duties and responsibilities impose
d on fishing vessel owners in accordance with the Convention, regardless of whether any
other organization or person fulfils certain of the duties or responsibilities on behalf
of the fishing vessel owner; .23 Fishing vessel personnel means every person employed or
engaged in any capacity or carrying out an occupation on board any fishing vessel, inclu
ding persons working on board who are paid on the basis of a share of the catch but excl
uding pilots, naval personnel, other persons in the permanent service --- URL: https://w
wwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC
.561(108).pdf but excluding pilots, naval personnel, other persons in the permanent serv
ice of a government, shore -based persons carrying out work aboard a fishing vessel and
fisheries observers; RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE
ANNEX TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHK
EEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention)
- 4 - .24 Function means a group of tasks, duties and responsibilities, as specified in
the STCW-F Code, necessary for fishing vessel operation, safety of life at sea or protec
tion of the marine environment; .25 Fishing training vessel means a dedicated training v
essel, designed for catching and storing fish, which provides a training opportunity for
demonstration and assessment of the competences required by the provisions of chapter II
of this annex; .26 GMDSS radio operator means a person who is qualified in accordance wi
th --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutio
ns/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf provisions of chapter II of this annex; .26 GMDSS rad
io operator means a person who is qualified in accordance with the provisions of regulat
ion II/6 of the Convention; .27 Certificate of competency means a certificate issued and
endorsed for skippers, officers and GMDSS radio operators in accordance with the provisi
ons of chapter II of this annex and entitling the lawful holder thereof to serve in the
capacity and perform the functions involved at t he level of responsibility specified th
erein; and .28 Certificate of proficiency means a certificate, other than a certificate
of competency issued to fishing vessel personnel, stating that the relevant requirements

of training, competencies or seagoing service in the Convention have been met.

2 These regulations are supplemented by the mandatory provisions contained in part A of the STCW-F Code and: .1 any reference to a requirement in a regulation also constitutes a reference to --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/Indexof IMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf of the STCW-F Code and: .1 any reference to a requirement in a regulation also constitutes a reference to the corresponding secti on of part A of the STCW-F Code; .2 in applying these regulations, the related guidance and explanatory material contained in part B of the STCW-F Code should be taken into acc ount to the greatest degree possible in order to achieve a more uniform implementation o f the Convention provisions on a global basis; .3 amendments to part A of the STCW -F Co de shall be adopted, brought into force and take effect in accordance with the provision s of article 10 of the Convention concerning the amendment procedure applicable to the a nnex; and .4 part B of the STCW -F Code shall be amended by the Maritime Safety Committe e in accordance with its rules of procedure.

Regulation I/2 Application 1 The Administration of a Party, if it considers it unreasona ble or impracticable to apply --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/Knowledg eCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf Regulation I/2 Application 1 The Administration of a Party, if it considers it unreasonable or impracticable to app ly the full requirements of regulations II/3, II/4 and II/5-1-1, II/5-1-2 or II/5-2 and the requirement of the use of the English language to personnel serving on boar d a fish ing vessel of less than 45 metres in length operating exclusively from its ports and fis hing within its limited waters, may determine which of these regulations should not appl y, wholly or in part, to such personnel, without derogation from the principles of safet y in the Convention.

In such a case, the Administration concerned shall report to the Secretary -General on t he details of the measures it has taken with respect to the training and certification o f such personnel.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNAT IONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo .org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108) .pdf AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, C ERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1 995 STCW-F Convention) - 5 - 2 For the purpose of this Convention, the Administration ma y decide to use the following gross tonnage in place of length (L) as the basis for meas urement for all chapters: .1 a gross tonnage of 300 shall be considered equivalent to a length (L) of 24 metres; and .2 a gross tonnage of 950 shall be considered equivalent to a length (L) of 45 metres.

Regulation I/3 Certificates and endorsements 1 Certificates of competency for fishing ve ssel personnel shall only be issued by the Administration if the requirements for servic e, age, medical fitness, training, qualification and examinations are met in accordance with these regulations.

2 A certificate of competency issued by a Party in compliance with paragraph 1 shall be --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/ MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf examinations are met in accordance with these regulation s.

2 A certificate of competency issued by a Party in compliance with paragraph 1 shall be endorsed by that Party attesting the issue of that certificate in the form as prescribed in format 1 or 2 of section A-I/3 of the STCW-F Code.

3 Certificates and endorsements shall be issued in the official language or languages of the issuing country.

If the language used is not English, the text shall include a translation into that lang uage.

4 In respect of radio operators, Parties may: .1 include the additional knowledge requir ed by regulation II/6 in the examination for the issue of a certificate complying with t he Radio Regulations; or .2 issue a separate certificate indicating that the holder has the additional knowledge required by regulation II/6.

5 The Administration which has recognized a certificate issued by or under the authority --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/ MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf knowledge required by regulation II/6.

5 The Administration which has recognized a certificate issued by or under the authority

of another Party in compliance with regulation I/7 shall issue an endorsement attesting the recognition of that certificate in the form prescribed in format 3 of section A-I/3 of the STCW-F Code.

6 The endorsement shall expire as soon as the certificate endorsed expires or is withdra wn, suspended or cancelled by the Party which issued it and, in any case, not more than five years after the date of issue.

7 Appropriate certificates of competency issued under the provisions of the 1978 STCW Co nvention for the holder to serve as a chief engineer officer, an engineer officer or GMD SS radio operator shall be deemed to be a corresponding certificate for the purposes of paragraph 1 with regard to fishing vessels.

8 Medical certificates issued in accordance with the provisions of regulation I/9 of --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCR esolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf paragraph 1 with regard to fishing vessels.

8 Medical certificates issued in accordance with the provisions of regulation I/9 of the 1978 STCW Convention shall be accepted as valid for the personnel of fishing vessels.

9 Subject to the variations permitted under formats 1, 2 and 3 of section A-I/3 of the S TCW-F Code, Administrations may use a format different from the format given in the sect ion provided that such format contains, as a minimum, the required information and that the particulars are inserted in Roman characters and Arabic figures.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNAT IONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VE SSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) - 6 - Regulation I/4 Control procedures 1 Control exercised by a duly authorized officer under article 8 shal l be limited to the following: --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/Knowled geCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf - 6 - Regulation I/4 Cont rol procedures 1 Control exercised by a duly authorized officer under article 8 shall be limited to the following: .1 verification that all fishing vessel personnel serving on b oard who are required to be certificated by this Convention are so certificated or hold the required dispensation.

Such certificates shall be accepted unless there are clear grounds for believing that a certificate has been fraudulently obtained or that the holder of a certificate is not th e person to whom that certificate was originally issued; and .2 assessment of the abilit y of the fishing vessel personnel to maintain watchkeeping standards as required by the Convention if there are clear grounds for believing that such standards are not being ma intained, because the following have occurred: .1 the vessel has been involved in a coll ision, grounding or stranding; or .2 there has been a discharge of substances from the v essel when --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOR esolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf .1 the vessel has been involved in a collisio n, grounding or stranding; or .2 there has been a discharge of substances from the vesse l when under way, at anchor or at berth which is illegal under international conventions ; or .3 the vessel has been manoeuvred in an erratic or unsafe manner, whereby routeing measures adopted by the Organization, or safe navigation practices and procedures, have not been followed; or .4 the vessel is otherwise being operated in such a manner as to p ose a danger to persons, property or the environment.

2 In the event that deficiencies are found under paragraph 1, the officer carrying out t he control shall forthwith inform, in writing, the skipper of the vessel and the Adminis tration, so that appropriate action may be taken.

Such notification shall specif y the details of the deficiencies found and the grounds o n which the Party determines that these deficiencies pose a danger to persons, property or the environment.

--- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/ MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf deficiencies found and the grounds on which the Party de termines that these deficiencies pose a danger to persons, property or the environment.

3 Deficiencies which may be deemed to pose a danger to persons, property or the environm ent include the following: .1 failure of persons, required to hold a certificate, to hav e an appropriate certificate or dispensation; .2 failure of navigational or engineering watch arrangements to conform to the requirements specified for the vessel by the Admini stration; .3 absence in a watch of a person qualified to operate equipment essential to safe navigation, safety radio communications or the prevention of pollution; or .4 inabi lity to provide rested persons for the first watch at the commencement of a voyage, and for subsequent relieving watches.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNAT IONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo .org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108) .pdf AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, C ERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1 995 STCW-F Convention) - 7 - Regulation I/5 Communication of information 1 The Secretary -General shall, on request, provide Parties with any information communicated under arti cle 4.

2 A Party which fails to communicate information required by article 4 within 24 months after the date of entry into force of the Convention for a Party shall not be entitled t o claim the privileges of this Convention until such time as the information has been re ceived by the Secretary-General.

Regulation I/6 Administration of certification arrangements 1 Each Party undertakes to e stablish and maintain a means of ensuring that programmes incorporating such instruction and practical training as is necessary to achieve the competency standards are regularly monitored to ensure their effectiveness.

--- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/ MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf the competency standards are regularly monitored to ensu re their effectiveness.

2 Each Party undertakes, to the extent practicable, to maintain a register or registers of all certificates and endorsements specified in regulations I/3 and II/1 to II/6 which are issued, have expired, or have been revalidated, reported lost, suspended or cancelle d, and of dispensations issued, and provide information on the status of such certificat es, endorsements and dispensations when so requested by another Party.

Regulation I/7 Recognition of certificates 1 Each Administration shall ensure, in order to recognize, by endorsement in accordance with regulation I/3, a certificate issued by or under the authority of another Party, that the requirements for standards of competen ce, as well as the issue and endorsement of certificates by that Party, are fully compli ed with.

2 Certificates issued by or under the authority of a non-Party shall not be recognized.

--- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/ MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf that Party, are fully complied with.

2 Certificates issued by or under the authority of a non-Party shall not be recognized.

3 Notwithstanding the requirement of paragraph 1 of this regulation and paragraph 5 of r egulation I/3, an Administration may, if circumstances require, allow a person to serve for a period not exceeding three months on board a vessel entitled to fly its flag while holding an appropriate and valid certificate issued by another Party without it being en dorsed as required by paragraph 5 of regulation I/3 provided that documented proof is ma de available that application for an endorsement has been submitted to the Administratio n.

Regulation I/8 Transitional provisions 1 A certificate of competency or of service in a capacity for which this Convention requires a certificate and which before entry into fo rce of the Convention for a Party is issued in accordance --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.or g/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pd f certificate and which before entry into force of the Convention for a Party is issued in accordance with the laws of that Party or the Radio Regulations shall be recognized a s valid for service after entry into force of the Convention for that Party.

2 After the entry into force of the Convention for a Party, it may continue to issue cer tificates of competency in accordance with its previous practices for a period not excee ding five years.

Such certificates shall be recognized as valid for the purpose of the Convention.

During this transitional period, such certificates shall be issued only to persons who h ad commenced their sea service before entry into force of the Convention for that Party within the specific vessel department to which those certificates relate.

The Party shall ensure that all other candidates for certification shall be examined and certificated in accordance with the Convention.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localre sources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf examine d and certificated in accordance with the Convention.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNAT IONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VE SSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) - 8 - 3 A Party may, within two years after entry into force of the Convention for that Party, issue a certif icate of service to fishing vessel personnel who hold neither an appropriate certificate under the Convention nor a certificate of competency issued unde r its laws before entry into force of the Convention for that Party but who have: .1 served in the capacity for which they seek a certificate of service for not less than three years at sea within the last seven years preceding entry into force of the Convention for that Party; .2 produce d evidence that they have performed that service satisfactorily; and --- URL: https://ww wcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC. 561(108).pdf of the Convention for that Party; .2 produced evidence that they have perfo rmed that service satisfactorily; and .3 satisfied the Party as to medical fitness, incl uding eyesight and hearing, taking into account their age at the time of application.

For the purpose of the Convention, a certificate of service issued under this paragraph shall be regarded as the equivalent of a certificate issued under the Convention.

Regulation I/9 Dispensation 1 In circumstances of exceptional necessity, an Administrati on, if in its opinion this will not cause danger to persons, property or the environment , may issue a dispensation permitting a person to serve in a specified fishing vessel fo r a specified period not exceeding six months in a capacity, other than that of the radi o operator, except as provided by the relevant Radio Regulations, for which the person d oes not hold the appropriate certificate, provided that the --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo. org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108). pdf Regulations, for which the person does not hold the appropriate certificate, provide d that the person to whom the dispensation is issued shall be adequately qualified to fi ll the vacant post in a safe manner, to the satisfaction of the Administration.

2 Any dispensation granted for a post shall be granted only to a person properly certifi cated to fill the post immediately below it.

Where certification of the post below is not required by the Convention, a dispensation may be issued to a person whose competence and experience are, in the opinion of the Adm inistration, clearly equivalent to the requirements for the post to be filled, provided that, if such a person holds no appropriate certificate, the person shall be required to pass a test accepted by th e Administration as demonstrating that such a dispensation ma y safely be issued.

In addition, the Administration shall ensure that the post in --- URL: https://wwwcdn.im o.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf dispensation may safely be issued.

In addition, the Administration shall ensure that the post in question is filled by the holder of an appropriate certificate as soon as possible.

3 Each Party shall, as soon as possible after 1 January each year, send a report to the Secretary-General giving information of the total number of dispensations in respect of each capacity for which a certificate is required, including nil returns.

Regulation I/10 Equivalents 1 The Convention shall not prevent a Party from retaining or adopting other educational and training arrangements, including those involving seagoing service and shipboard organization especially adapted to technical developments and to s pecial types of vessels, provided that the level of seagoing service, knowledge and effi ciency as regards navigational and technical handling of vessels ensures a degree of saf ety at sea and has a preventive effect --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en /KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf and technical han dling of vessels ensures a degree of safety at sea and has a preventive effect as regard s pollution at least equivalent to the requirements of the Convention.

2 Details of such arrangements shall be included in the report under article 4.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNAT IONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VE SSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) - 9 - Regulation I/11 Use of simulators 1 The performance standards and other provisions set forth in section A-I/11 and such other requirements as are prescribed in part A of the STCW -F Code for a ny certificate concerned shall be complied with in respect of: .1 all simulator-based tr aining; .2 any assessment of competency required by part A of the STCW -F Code which is carried out by means of a simulator; and .3 any demonstration, by means of a simulator, of continued proficiency --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCent

re/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf which is carried out by means o
f a simulator; and .3 any demonstration, by means of a simulator, of continued proficien
cy required by part A of the STCW-F Code.

Regulation I/12 Medical standards 1 Each Party shall establish standards of medical fitn
ess for fishing vessel personnel and procedures for the issue of a medical certificate i
n accordance with the provisions of this regulation and of section A-I/12 of the STCW-F
Code.

2 Each Party shall ensure that those responsible for assessing the medical fitness of fi
shing vessel personnel are medical practitioners recognized by the Party for the purpose
of fishing vessel personnel medical examinations, in accordance with the provis ions of
section A-I/12 of the STCW-F Code.

3 Every crew member holding a certificate issued under the provisions of the Convention
who is serving at sea shall also hold a valid medical certificate issued in --- URL: htt
ps://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutio
ns/MSC.561(108).pdf Convention who is serving at sea shall also hold a valid medical cer
tificate issued in accordance with the provisions of this regulation and of section A-I/
12 of the STCW-F Code.

4 Every candidate for certification shall: .1 be not less than 16 years of age; or .2 be
not less than 15 years of age provided that the candidate is authorized by the competent
authority in accordance with national laws and practice; .3 provide satisfactory proof o
f his or her identity; and .4 meet the applicable medical fitness standards established
by the Party.

5 Medical certificates shall remain valid for a maximum period of two years unless the c
rew member is under the age of 18, in which case the maximum period of validity shall be
one year.

6 If the period of validity of a medical certificate expires in the course of a voyage,
then the medical certificate shall continue in force until the next port of call where a
medical --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOReso
lutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf the medical certificate shall continue in force
until the next port of call where a medical practitioner recognized by the Party is avai
lable, provided that the period shall not exceed three months.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNAT
IONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VE
SSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) - 10 - 7 In urgent ca
ses the Administration may permit a crew member to work without a valid medical certific
ate until the next port of call where a medical practitioner recognized by the Party is
available, provided that: .1 the period of permission does not exceed three months; and
.2 the crew member concerned is in possession of an expired medical certificate of recen
t date.

CHAPTER II Certification of skippers, officers in charge of a navigational watch, engine
er officers and radio operators Regulation II/1 --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localres
ources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf CHAPTER
II Certification of skippers, officers in charge of a navigational watch, engineer offic
ers and radio operators Regulation II/1 Mandatory minimum requirements for certification
of skippers on fishing vessels of 24 metres in length and over operating in unlimited wa
ters 1 Every skipper on a fishing vessel of 24 metres in length and over operating in un
limited waters shall hold a certificate of competency.

2 Every candidate for certification shall: .1 meet the requirements for certification as
an officer in charge of a navigational watch on fishing vessels of 24 metres in length a
nd over operating in unlimited waters, and have approved seagoing service of not less th
an 12 months as an officer in charge of a navigational watch or skipper on fishing vesse
ls of not less than 12 metres in length.

However, the Party may allow the substitution of a period not exceeding six months of ap
proved seagoing service as an officer in charge of --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/local
resources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf not e
xceeding six months of approved seagoing service as an officer in charge of a navigation
al watch on seagoing ships covered by the 1978 STCW Convention; and .2 meet the standard
of competence specified in section A-II/1 of the STCW-F Code.

3 A candidate who holds a valid certificate of competency issued in accordance with the
provisions of the 1978 STCW Convention need not be reassessed in those standards of comp
etence listed in section A -II/1 of the STCW -F Code that were required at a highe r or

equivalent level for the issuance of the corresponding 1978 STCW Convention certificate.

Regulation II/2 Mandatory minimum requirements for certification of officers in charge o f a navigational watch on fishing vessels of 24 metres in length and over operating in u nlimited waters 1 Every officer in charge of a navigational watch on a fishing vessel of 24 metres in length and over operating in unlimited waters shall hold a certificate of c ompetency.

--- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/ MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf length and over operating in unlimited waters shall hold a certificate of competency.

2 Every candidate for certification shall: .1 be not less than 18 years of age; .2 have approved seagoing service of not less than: .1 12 months on fishing vessels or fishing t raining vessels of not less than 12 metres in length as part of an approved training pro gramme which includes onboard training that meets the requirements of section A -II/2 of the STCW -F Code and is documented in an approved training record book; or RESOLUTION MS C.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENT ION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSONNE L, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) - 11 - .2 two years in the deck de partment on fishing vessels of not less than 12 metres in length.

However, the Administration may allow the substitution of the seagoing service by a peri od of special training --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre /IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf than 12 metres in length.

However, the Administration may allow the substitution of the seagoing service by a peri od of special training not exceeding one year, provided that the period of the special t raining programme shall be at least equivalent in value to the period of the required se agoing service it substitutes or by a period of approved seagoing service evidenced by a n approved record book covered by the 1978 STCW Convention; .3 meet the standard of comp etence specified in section A-II/2 of the STCW-F Code; and .4 meet the applicable requir ements of regulation II/6, as appropriate for performing designated radio duties in acco rdance with the Radio Regulations.

3 A candidate who holds a valid certificate of competency issued in accordance with the provisions of the 1978 STCW Convention need not be reassessed in those standards of comp etence listed in section A -II/2 of the STCW -F Code that were required at a highe r or --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/ MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf competence listed in section A -II/2 of the STCW -F Code that were required at a highe r or equivalent level for the issuance of the correspondin g 1978 STCW Convention certificate.

Regulation II/3 Mandatory minimum requirements for certification of skippers on fishing vessels of 24 metres in length and over operating in limited waters 1 Every skipper on a fishing vessel of 24 metres in length and over operating in limited waters shall, unless they hold certificates issued in compliance with regulation II/1, hold a certificate of competency issued in compliance with at least the provisions of this regulation.

2 Every candidate for certification shall: .1 meet the requirements for certification as an officer in charge of a navigational watch on fishing vessels of 24 metres in length a nd over operating in limited or unlimited waters, and have approved seagoing service of not less than 12 months as an officer in charge of a navigational watch or --- URL: http s://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolution s/MSC.561(108).pdf of not less than 12 months as an officer in charge of a navigational watch or skipper on fishing vessels of not less than 12 metres in length.

However, a Party may allow the substitution of a period not exceeding six months o f app roved seagoing service as an officer in charge of a navigational watch on seagoing ships covered by the 1978 STCW Convention; and .2 meet the standard of competence specified in section A-II/3 of the STCW-F Code.

3 The Party, bearing in mind the effect on the safety of all vessels and structures whic h may be operating in the same limited waters, should consider the limited waters it has defined in accordance with the definition given in regulation I/1 and determine any addi tional material that should be included in the standard of competence.

4 A candidate who holds a valid certificate of competency issued in accordance with the provisions of the 1978 STCW Convention need not be reassessed in those standards of --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCR esolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf the provisions of the 1978 STCW Convention need not be reass essed in those standards of competence listed in section A -II/3 of the STCW -F Code tha

t were required at a highe r or equivalent level for the issuance of the corresponding 1
978 STCW Convention certificate.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNAT
IONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VE
SSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) - 12 - Regulation II/
4 Mandatory minimum requirements for certification of officers in charge of a navigation
al watch on fishing vessels of 24 metres in length and over operating in limited waters
1 Every officer in charge of a navigational watch on a fishing vessel of 24 metres in le
ngth and over operating in limited waters shall either hold a certificate issued in comp
liance with regulation II/2 or hold a certificate of competency issued in compliance wit
h at least the --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/Indexof
IMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf with regulation II/2 or hold a certificat
e of competency issued in compliance with at least the provisions of this regulation.

2 Every candidate for certification shall: .1 be not less than 18 years of age; .2 have
approved seagoing service of not less than: .1 12 months on fishing vessels or fishing t
raining vessels of not less than 12 metres in length as part of an approved training pro
gramme which includes onboard training that meets the requirements of section A -II/4 of
the STCW -F Code and is documented in an approved training record book; or .2 two years
in the deck department on fishing vessels of not less than 12 metres in length.

However, the Administration may allow the substitution of the seagoing service by a peri
od of special training not exceeding one year, provided that the period of the special t
raining programme shall be at least equivalent in value to the period of the required se
agoing service it substitutes or by a period of --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localres
ources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf training
programme shall be at least equivalent in value to the period of the required seagoing s
ervice it substitutes or by a period of approved seagoing service evidenced by an approv
ed record book covered by the 1978 STCW Convention; .3 meet the standard of competence s
pecified in section A-II/4 of the STCW-F Code; and .4 meet the appropriate requirements
for performing designated radio duties in accordance with the Radio Regulations.

3 A candidate who holds a valid certificate of competency issued in accordance with the
provisions of the 1978 STCW Convention need not be reassessed in those standards of comp
etence listed in section A -II/4 of the STCW-F Code, which were required at a hig her or
equivalent level for the issuance of the corresponding 1978 STCW Convention certificate.

Regulation II/5-1-1 Mandatory minimum requirements for certification of chief engineer o
fficers and second engineer officers on fishing vessels powered by main propulsion machi
nery --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolut
ions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf second engineer officers on fishing vessels powered
by main propulsion machinery of 3,000 kW propulsion power or more 1 Every chief engineer
officer and second engineer officer on a seagoing fishing vessel powered by main propuls
ion machinery of 3,000 kW propulsion power or more shall hold a certificate of competenc
y.

2 Every candidate for certification shall: .1 meet the requirements for certification as
an officer in charge of an engineering watch on fishing vessels powered by main propulsi
on machinery of 750 kW propulsion power or more and have approved seagoing service in th
at capacity: RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO
THE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FO
R FISHING VESSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) - 13 - .1
for certification as second engineer officer, have not less than 12 months as qualified
engineer officer; and --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/
IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf - 13 - .1 for certification as sec
ond engineer officer, have not less than 12 months as qualified engineer officer; and .2
for certification as chief engineer officer, have not less than 36 months; however, this
period may be reduced to not less than 24 months if not less than 12 months of such seag
oing service has been served as second engineer officer; and .2 have completed approved
education and training and meet the standard of competence specified in section A-II/5-1
-1 of the STCW-F Code.

Regulation II/5-1-2 Mandatory minimum requirements for certification of chief engineer o
fficers and second engineer officers on fishing vessels powered by main propulsion machi
nery of between 750 kW and 3,000 kW propulsion power 1 Every chief engineer officer and
second engineer officer on a seagoing fishing vessel powered by main propulsion machiner
y of between 750 kW and 3,000 kW propulsion power shall hold a certificate of competency
.

2 Every candidate for certification shall: --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresource
s/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf shall hold a
certificate of competency.

2 Every candidate for certification shall: .1 meet the requirements for certification as
an officer in charge of an engineering watch on fishing vessels powered by main propulsi
on machinery of 750 kW propulsion power or more and: .1 for certification as second engi
neer officer, have not less than 12 months of approved seagoing service as assistant eng
ineer officer or engineer officer; and .2 for certification as chief engineer officer, h
ave not less than 24 months of approved seagoing service of which not less than 12 month
s shall be served while qualified to serve as second engineer officer; and .2 have compl
eted approved education and training and meet the standard of competence specified in se
ction A-II/5-1-2 of the STCW-F Code.

3 Every engineer officer who is qualified to serve as second engineer officer on fishing
vessels powered by main propulsion machinery of 3,000 kW propulsion or more, may serve -
-- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/M
SCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf vessels powered by main propulsion machinery of 3,000 kW
propulsion or more, may serve as chief engineer officer on fishing vessels powered by ma
in propulsion machinery of less than 3,000 kW propulsion power, provided the certificate
is so endorsed.

Regulation II/5-2 Mandatory minimum requirements for certification of officers in charge
of an engineering watch in a manned engine -room or designated duty engineers in a perio
dically unmanned engine-room on fishing vessels powered by main propulsion machinery of
750 kW propulsion power or more 1 Every officer in charge of an engineering watch in a m
anned engine -room or designated duty engineer officer in a periodically unmanned engine
-room serving on a seagoing fishing vessel powered by main propulsion machinery of 750 k
W propulsion power or more shall hold a certificate of competency.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localre
sources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf or more
shall hold a certificate of competency.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNAT
IONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VE
SSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) - 14 - 2 Every candid
ate for certification shall: .1 be not less than 18 years of age; .2 have completed 12 m
onths of combined workshop skills training and approved seagoing service of which not le
ss than six months must be served on board fishing vessels or fishing training vessels a
s part of an approved training programme which includes onboa rd training that meets the
requirements of section A-II/5-2 of the STCW-F Code and is documented in an approved tra
ining record book; or .3 have completed 12 months of combined workshop skills training a
nd approved seagoing service of which not less than six months must be served on ships -
-- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/M
SCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf seagoing service of which not less than six months must b
e served on ships or training ships being operated in accordance with the 1978 STCW Conv
ention as part of an approved training programme which includes onboard training that me
ets the requirements of section A -II/5-2 of the STCW-F Code and is documented in an app
roved training record book; or .4 have approved seagoing service of not less than 12 mon
ths in the engine - room.

However, the Administration may allow, as deemed necessary, the substitution of up to si
x months of the seagoing service by a period of special training such as workshop skill
s training, provided that the special training programme is equivalent in value to the p
eriod of the required seagoing service it substitutes; and .5 meet the standard of compe
tence specified in section A -II/5-2 of the STCW-F Code.

3 The Party may vary the requirements for standard of competence and seagoing --- URL: h
ttps://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolut
ions/MSC.561(108).pdf STCW-F Code.

3 The Party may vary the requirements for standard of competence and seagoing service fo
r officers of fishing vessels engaged in voyages in limited waters bearing in mind the p
ower of the propulsion machinery and the effect on the safety of all fishing vessels whi
ch may be operating in the same waters.

4 Training to achieve the necessary theoretical knowledge and practical experience shall
take into account relevant international regulations and recommendations.

Regulation II/6 Mandatory minimum requirements for certification of GMDSS radio operator

s on board fishing vessels Explanatory note Mandatory provisions relating to radio watch keeping are set forth in the Radio Regulations and in the 2012 Cape Town Agreement.

Provisions for radio maintenance are set forth in the 2012 Cape Town Agreement.

The referred provisions are mandatory in the Radio Regulations and will be mandatory in the 2012 Cape Town Agreement when it enters into force.

Application --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMO Resolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.561(108).pdf will be mandatory in the 2012 Cape Town Agre ement when it enters into force.

Application 1 Except as provided in paragraph 2, the provisions of this regulation shall apply to radio operators on fishing vessels operating within the Global Maritime Distres s and Safety System (GMDSS) as prescribed by the international conventions.

RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNAT IONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VE SSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) --- URL: https://wwwc dn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.56 1(108).pdf RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO T HE INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSONNEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) RESOLUTION MSC.561(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE ANNEX TO THE INTERNATIONAL CONVE NTION ON STANDARDS OF TRAINING, CERTIFICATION AND WATCHKEEPING FOR FISHING VESSEL PERSON NEL, 1995 (Revised annex to the 1995 STCW-F Convention) THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE, R ECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization conc erning the functions of the Committee, RECALLING ALSO article 10 of the International Co nvention on Standards of Training, Certification a